

In 1905, Lord Minto was appointed as Viceroy of India in place of Lord Curzon and John Morley was appointed as Secretary of state for India. The reforms introduced by them are known as Morley-Minto Reforms. The Indian Councils Act, 1909, commonly known as the Morley-Minto Reforms was an Act of the Parliament of the United Kingdom that brought about a limited increase in the involvement of Indians in the governance of British India. The major dispute regarding this act was separate electorate for Muslims in India.

2. The Indian Council Act of 1909 was provided for :

- (a) Dyarchy
- (b) Communal representation
- (c) Federation
- (d) Provincial autonomy

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (b)

The main fault of the Indian Council Act, 1909 (Morley-Minto) was a system of communal representation for Muslims by accepting the concept of "separate electorate." According to this system, Muslim members were to be elected only by Muslim electorates, not by general electorates in Councils. Indeed it meant that the Muslim community was considered as an absolutely separate class from India. Antiquated National integrity vanished in only one storm. Gandhi Stated:- "Morley-Minto Reforms have destroyed everything."

3. Seeds of discord were in which event during National Movement and which eventually divided the country, was—

- (a) Establishment of Muslim League in 1906.
- (b) Division of Bengal in 1905.
- (c) Khilafat Movement Supported by Gandhiji.
- (d) Reservation of seats and separate electorates for Muslims in legislative assemblies.

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Pre) 2004
U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (d)

The Minto-Morley reforms are known to envisage a separate electorate for Muslims, and this had a long lasting impact on Indian polity. This was for the first time that Muslim community was recognized as a completely separate section of the Indian Nation and this triggered "A Cancer" in India called "Hindu-Muslim Disharmony" which later culminated in the Partition of India and Pakistan. Separate constituencies were marked for the Muslims, and only Muslim community members were given the right to elect their representatives. The principle of communal representation which was accepted under the Morley-Minto Reforms was retained and was pushed further by the Government of India Act, 1919.

4. Whom did Rajendra Prasad consider as the father of Pakistan?

- (a) Md. Jinnah
- (b) Lord Mountbatten
- (c) Lord Minto
- (d) Liaquat Ali Khan
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C (Pre.) 2017

Ans. (c)

Lord Minto was part of the Minto-Morley reforms of 1909 A.D. which introduced communal electorates in India and thus sowed the seeds of partition of India. Rajendra Prasad thus rightly considered him as Father of Pakistan.

Delhi Durbar and Change of Capital

*In **December 1911**, a grand **Delhi Durbar** was organized to welcome British King **George V** and **Queen Mary**. George V annulled the Partition of Bengal on 12th December, 1911, and shifted the capital to **Delhi** from **Calcutta**. It was announced that Bengal would be reconstituted as a new province. Odisha and Bihar were separated. The Bengal got the identity of a new province in 1912. Assam was restored to its previous position of 1874.

1. Where was the Capital of India before Delhi under British period?

- (a) Calcutta
- (b) Bombay
- (c) Patna
- (d) Lucknow

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (a)

During the British Rule, until 1911 A.D., Calcutta (now Kolkata) was the capital of India. King George V, the king of England visited India to attend Delhi Durbar in 1911 A.D. and announced the transfer of capital from Calcutta to Delhi on December 12, 1911 A.D. The capital of India shifted from Calcutta to Delhi during the tenure of Lord Hardinge II in 1912 A.D.

2. The transfer of capital of British India from Calcutta to Delhi was affected during the period of —

- (a) Lord Mayo
- (b) Lord Lawrence
- (c) Lord Minto
- (d) Lord Hardinge

U.P.P.C.S (Pre) 1990

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

3. Delhi became the capital of India in :

- (a) 1910 (b) 1911
(c) 1916 (d) 1923

Uttarakhand U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2007

Ans. (b)

It is notable that King George V proclaimed the transfer the capital from Calcutta to Delhi, but this transfer was completed in 1912. So if 1911 and 1912 both options are given, then 1912 would be preferred.

4. In which year the Capital of India has been transferred from Calcutta to Delhi?

- (a) 1901 (b) 1905
(c) 1911 (d) 1912

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Mains) 2006

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

5. When did Britishers shifted the capital to Delhi ?

- (a) 1912
(b) 1913
(c) 1911
(d) More than one of the above

70th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

6. In which year the capital of India was transferred from Calcutta to Delhi?

- (a) 1905 A.D. (b) 1909 A.D.
(c) 1910 A.D. (d) 1911 A.D.

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2008

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

7. A bomb was thrown on the occasion of his State entry into Delhi :

- (a) Lord Curzon (b) Lord Mayo
(c) Lord Minto (d) Lord Hardinge

U.P. Lower Sub. (Spl) (Pre) 2008

Ans. (d)

The Delhi Conspiracy case, also known as the Delhi-Lahore Conspiracy, refers to a conspiracy in 1912 to assassinate the then Viceroy of India, Lord Hardinge-II, on the occasion of transferring the capital of British India from Calcutta to Delhi. Hatched by the Indian revolutionary underground in Bengal and Punjab and headed by Rash Behari Bose, the conspiracy culminated in the attempted assassination on 23 December, 1912 when a homemade bomb was thrown into the Viceroy's Howdah when the ceremonial procession moved through the Chandni Chowk suburb of Delhi.

8. The revolutionary, who was not involved in Hardinge Bomb incident?

- (a) Master Amir Chand
(b) Bhagwati Charan Vohara
(c) Bhai Balmukund
(d) Avadh Bihari

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (b)

The Hardinge Bomb Case is popularly known as the Delhi Conspiracy Case. Fourteen persons were made accused in this, in which Awadh Bihari, Master Amir Chand, Balmukund and Basant Biswas were given death sentence and Balraj and Harvansh Sahay were given life Imprisonment. Dinanath had turned approver. Bhagwati Charan Vohra was not in it. Rash Behari Bose, who played the main role in this, fled to Japan and escaped the trial.

9. Which among the following organisations was responsible for throwing a bomb at Viceroy Lord Hardinge in Delhi?

- (a) Anushilan Samiti
(b) All India Labour Association
(c) Yugantar
(d) United Patriotic Association

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (a)

Anushilan Samiti was responsible for throwing a bomb at Viceroy Lord Hardinge II in Delhi. It was an assault on Viceroy Lord Hardinge's life. Rash Behari Bose served as the leader of the revolt. In the sentencing of this Delhi conspiracy case, Basant Kumar Biswas, Bhai Balmukund, Amir Chand and Avadh Bihari were among found guilty and put to death.

10. Bihar became a separate state during the British rule in the year :

- (a) 1905 (b) 1912
(c) 1936 (d) 1946

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (b)

In December, 1911, the imperial court (Delhi Durbar) was organized for greeting the arrival of British King George V and Queen Mary to India. British emperor proclaimed cancellation of Bengal partition in Delhi Durbar as well as separated Bihar and Orissa from Bengal. In 1912, Bihar, and Orissa were separated from Bengal and organised in administrative units.

11. When was Bihar first separated from the Bengal Presidency under the British-ruled India?

- (a) 1912 (b) 1936
(c) 1947 (d) None of the above

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (a)